



42

FACILITIES  
OPERATED BY  
NARAYANA  
HEALTH

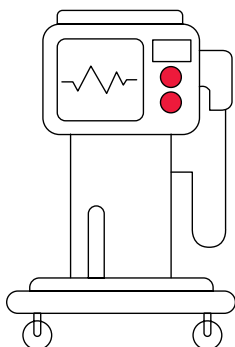
₹900

CRORE INVESTED  
IN INDIA AND  
IN THE CAYMAN  
ISLANDS IN FY24

1,435

BEDS THAT  
NARAYANA  
HEALTH IS  
LOOKING TO  
ADD TO THE  
EXISTING 5,098

72 |



BEST CEOs

**DR. DEVI SHETTY**

MOST TRUSTED LEADER

# BUILDING TRUST

Dr. Devi Shetty set up Narayana Health to make healthcare more affordable. With steady growth over the years, he is now setting sights on expanding abroad

BY **NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA**

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**IN 1989, WHEN** Dr. Devi Shetty left England and returned to India, the cardiac surgeon had no plans of building a hospital empire. He was content working at established institutions. But he was troubled by one question: why was quality healthcare a privilege tied to wealth?

During Shetty's early medical training, he had assumed that as a country grew richer, healthcare would naturally become more accessible. That was not the case. "I saw the richest country in the world, the United States, struggling to

provide healthcare to its citizens. That meant that India's becoming rich would not necessarily translate into affordable healthcare for everyone."

That realisation turned into Shetty's life's mission. He wanted to build a system where healthcare was not a luxury but a right. "My only objective was to bring down the cost of heart care for the common man in the country," says 71-year-old Shetty.

Shetty's father-in-law, construction magnate Charmakki Narayana Shetty, offered to fund his first hospital. What started as a single hospital in Kolkata soon expanded to Bengaluru and beyond. But Shetty, Founder & Chairman of Narayana Health, never imagined that his venture would scale to its current level. "We thought we would build one or two hospitals and see how it goes," he says. "Many factors came into play, and a lot of good people joined the mission. We reached this level mainly because the